years old. It has lost about 60 percent of its initial value by then. When you buy a pre-owned car, you end up paying less and mitigate against depreciation. You don’t want the cheapest car that compromises safety or nickel and dimes you with constant repairs. This is a perfect example of being a valuist—choosing the car that provides the most value for the lowest cost.

Even if you can not afford to buy your next car with cash, these practical choices can save substantial amounts of money. When you can purchase your car with cash, you eliminate the expense of financing your vehicle.

Most people who finance their car purchase continue doing it again and again, paying unnecessary expenses their entire adult lives. Even worse, others lease vehicles with this same pattern. Many get into the habit of having a car loan or lease payment, and that becomes the normal rhythm of their lives. They often think, “This car is paid off, it must be time for a new one.” Those who *Choose FI* challenge this “conventional” wisdom.

Eating Your Way to FI

The third key focal point to cut spending and shorten the road to FI is controlling food costs. The cost of a meal is insignificant